

SENATE RESOLUTION 38

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Kevin Whalum of Memphis.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts and artistic contributions, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is Kevin Whalum of Memphis, an exceptional vocalist in the soul, jazz, scat, and gospel genres; and

WHEREAS, Kevin Whalum hails from the highly respected Whalum family of Memphis, the members of which, over four generations, have distinguished themselves time and again in the fields of music, worship, and public service; and

WHEREAS, Kevin Whalum grew up in Memphis, where he attended Olivet Fellowship Baptist Church, led by his father; the church, known for its singers and musicians, created both a religious and a musical foundation for a young Kevin Whalum; and

WHEREAS, following his graduation from Morehouse College, Mr. Whalum moved to Chicago, Illinois, where he worked a sales job during the day and played with the band Fast Forward in the evenings; and

WHEREAS, Kevin Whalum moved to Nashville and appeared as a guest vocalist on his brother's 1997 release, *The Gospel According to Jazz, Chapter 1*, and as a part of his band at that year's Stellar Awards; and

WHEREAS, two years later, Mr. Whalum went into the music industry full time and became a popular live and session vocalist in Nashville's soul music scene; and

WHEREAS, Kevin Whalum's extensive artistic journey led to his project *Timetable*; the independent album explored multiple genres while simultaneously introducing his musical aptitude to his audience and showcasing his love for faith, family, and music; and

WHEREAS, for several years, Mr. Whalum dedicated his time and talents as a background singer before returning to the studio with producers George Duke and Rex Rideout, among others, and releasing *One Life to Love* in 2008; and

WHEREAS, his professional accomplishments aside, Kevin Whalum enjoys the love and support of his wife, Camille, whom he married in 1996; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Whalum epitomizes the spirit and commitment that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, it is most fitting that the members of this legislative body should pause to honor Kevin Whalum's commitment to excellence in faith, musical artistry, and family; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and commend Kevin Whalum for his indelible contributions to the music industry and extend to him our best wishes for continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.